

SENATE BILL 644

By Crowe

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49
and Title 63, relative to schools of nursing.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 63, Chapter 7, Part 2, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

Notwithstanding § 63-7-207(7), for practical nursing programs offered by a public institution of higher education, the board shall require:

- (1) That students enrolled in a practical nursing program meet the qualifications for a high school diploma or the equivalent; and
- (2) That practical nursing program students have access to pre-practical nursing or practical nursing program curricula starting as early as the freshman year of high school, or as allowable by the dual enrollment grant as described in § 49-4-930.

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 63-7-207, is amended by deleting subdivision (7) and substituting the following:

- (7) Prescribe the minimum curricula and minimum standards for schools of nursing and for courses of training preparing persons for licensure under this chapter and provide for surveys of such schools or an affiliation of schools and courses. For practical nursing programs offered by a public institution of higher education, the board shall:
 - (A) Require a minimum of one thousand two hundred ninety-six (1,296) clock hours or an equivalent number of credit hours; and

(B) Permit a student of the practical nursing program to sit for the national council licensure exam for practical nurses (NCLEX-PN) upon completion of the practical nursing program, as long as the student meets the NCLEX-PN minimum age requirements as set by the national council of state boards of nursing;

SECTION 3. This act takes effect July 1, 2025, the public welfare requiring it.